

title: "Accessibility: Best Practices" lang: en-US

## Accessibility: Best Practices

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When creating course content, following the practices below will help you address accessibility efficiently and effectively. When possible, build content directly in Canvas. Limit Canvas uploads to Word and PPTX when possible. Use pdf only when needed i.e. - the file size is more than 500MB - the tables must have merged or empty cells - maintaining layout of the document is imperative. When converting from Word to PDF, use the "Save as" feature to preserve accessibility. Avoid converting PowerPoints to PDF. When possible link to outside resources such as journal articles. Uploading them as pdfs in Canvas will require you to ensure their accessibility. Prioritize accessibility of frequently used documents. When remediating, if possible, start with the original version of the document. Use Canvas Studio for videos; it generates captions automatically which are ~85% accurate, so a review is still needed. You may contact your instructional design or media team to request captions. Always use the built-in accessibility checker (in office 365 products, PDF and Canvas) and perform manual checks. Note that an accessible word document does not always result in an accessible PDF.?

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